

In 1497, Vasco da Gama sailed from Portugal to India.

Christopher Columbus sailed from Spain to the Caribbean in 1492.

In 1519, Ferdinand Magellan sailed from Spain to the Pacific.



Vasco da Gama



Christopher Columbus

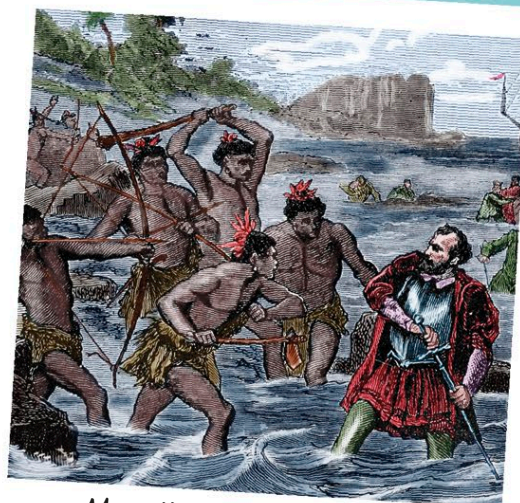


Ferdinand Magellan

Death of Magellan

Ferdinand Magellan led the first ever crossing of the Pacific Ocean.

When he reached Mactan Island in April 1521, he was killed in a battle with local people.



Magellan being attacked

Zheng He was a Chinese admiral who led seven voyages to explore south Asia and east Africa.



Zheng He

OTTOMAN EMPIRE

PERSIAN EMPIRE

MUGHAL EMPIRE

MING EMPIRE

PACIFIC OCEAN

ARABIA

AFRICA

THE PHILIPPINES

THE SPICE ISLANDS

Magellan's death in the Philippines didn't stop his crew from continuing their voyage of discovery.

Zheng He sailed with fleets of huge ships called junks.



Chinese junk ship

INDIAN OCEAN



The Victoria

The Victoria was the only one of Magellan's five ships to complete the voyage.

The spice routes

One of the main aims of European explorers was to find new spices. These included pepper from India and nutmeg and cloves from the Spice Islands. They could be sold for great sums of money back in Europe.

